

A smiling man with glasses and a striped shirt is standing in a library, holding a book. The background is filled with bookshelves.

Welcome!

We will begin at 9.30am

(Italy time)

- Now that you have joined, please ensure that your mic is muted.
- If you have any questions throughout the info session, please write them in the Chat section located in the right side of the panel. There will be opportunity to have your questions answered at the end.
- If the speakers are talking too fast for you, please inform us in the Chat section.
- This info session will be recorded and sent to the attendees upon request via email at unicore@unhcr.org.

Enhancing the UNICORE Experience

Key Findings from the 2025 Student
Survey
23rd July 2025

Agenda

- **Presentation of the 2025 UNICORE Student Survey Results**

Speaker: Luisa Bianco UNHCR MCO Italy

Key findings, insights, and recommendations based on student feedback.

- **Mental Health and Psychosocial Wellbeing**

Speaker: Sofia Casas UNHCR RBE

A focused session on student wellbeing, mental health, and support strategies.

- **Inclusion Pathways for Refugees – UNHCR Programmes**

Speaker: Andrea De Bonis UNHCR MCO Italy

Presentation of the new leaflet and an overview of UNHCR's initiatives to support refugee inclusion, with a focus on the post-graduation phase.

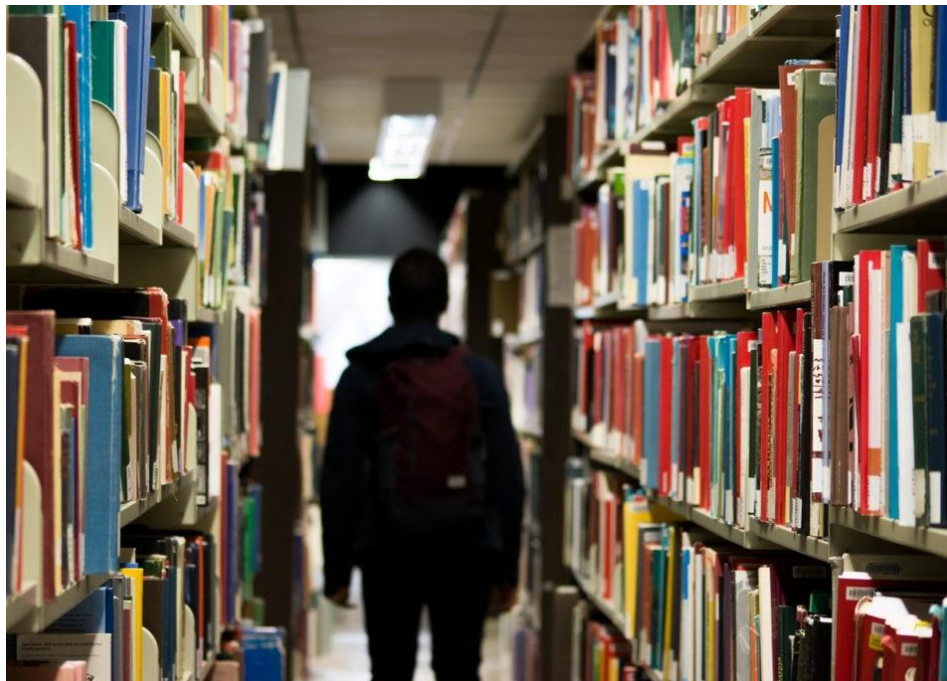
- **Nothing for us without us**

Speaker: Yohannes Sisay Molla ICMC, UNICORE graduate

Why refugee and migrant participation is essential for meaningful inclusion.

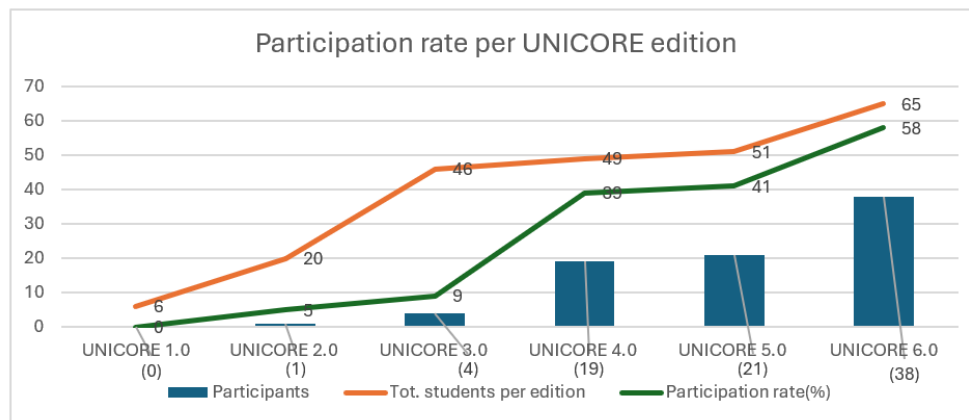
- **Q&A Session**

Open floor for questions, reflections, and discussion.



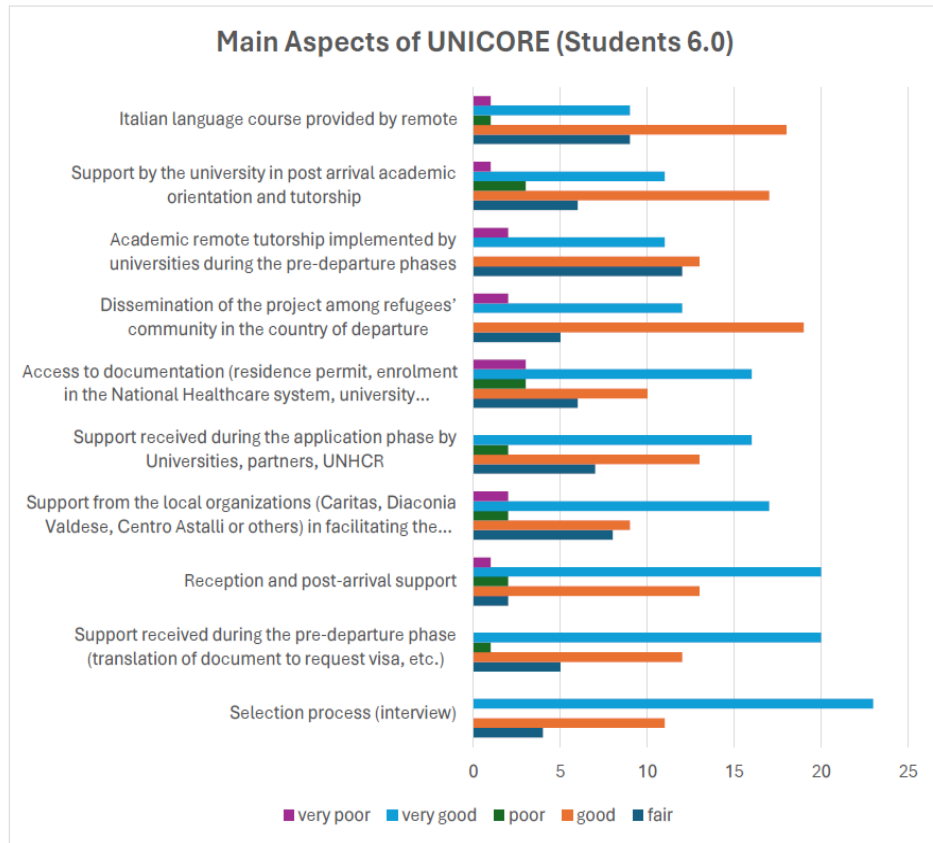
UNICORE 2025 Student Survey – Key Findings

- Insights from 83 respondents across 6 UNICORE editions
- Survey conducted in March 2025
- Participation rate: 44%



What's Working Well

- High appreciation for selection process (60.5% rated 'Very good')
- Strong support during pre-departure and post-arrival phases
- Positive feedback on local organization support and documentation access

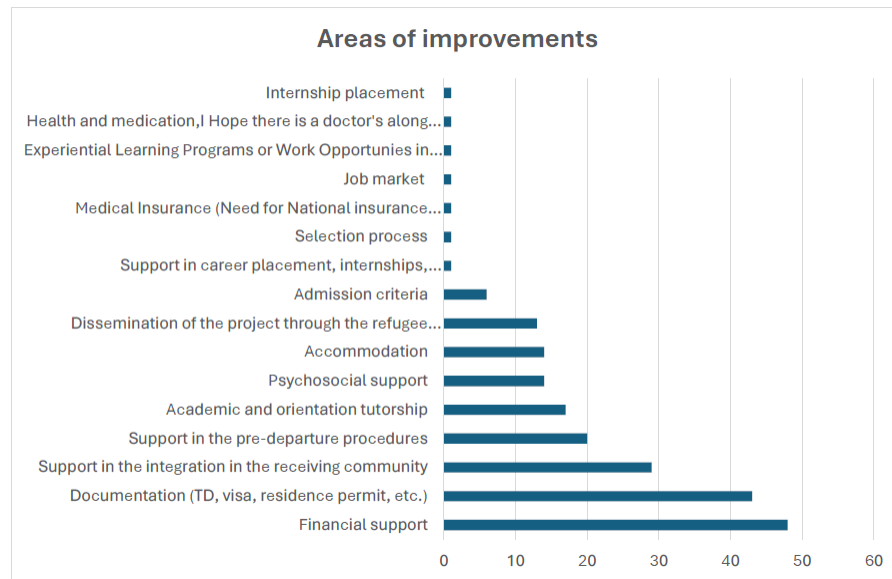


Digital Experience

- Clarity of university calls: 4.34/5
- Ease of navigating UNICORE website: 4.11/5
- Application process experience: 4.18/5

Areas for Improvement

- Financial support (48 mentions)
- Documentation delays (43 mentions)
- Integration support (29 mentions)
- Pre-departure procedures, academic tutorship, and psychosocial support



Student Recommendations

- Harmonize **financial and accommodation support**
- Improve **access to healthcare and psychological services**
- Extend **scholarship duration** to include language learning
- Enhance **post-graduation support and mentorship**

Mental Health and Wellbeing



Need for structured psychological support



Requests for psychosocial monitoring and social inclusion activities

Quotes:

"More efforts should be focused on psychological support upon arrival in Italy."

"I recommend, if possible, that psychosocial monitoring be implemented for students to understand their level of integration and the challenges they face in the academic environment, especially in the first year."

Discrimination and Belonging

- Reports of racism and exclusion
- Need for safe, inclusive environments and responsive support

- ZERO TOLERANCE APPROACH
- Please report eventual episodes to partners and UNHCR

Post-Graduation and Inclusion



Uncertainty about future
after graduation



Need for clearer integration
pathways and job
placement

Quotes:

"UNICORE helps empower us through education and career opportunities, but life after graduation is unclear. We come from refugee backgrounds and are expected to work as internationals, which is complicated. Integration into Italy as refugees should be considered, especially since we are educated and can contribute."

"Close follow-up and support in job placement after graduation is essential. Networking between alumni and current students, more activities to amplify the UNICORE project, and a Career Day for refugee graduates would make a big difference."

"I needed a mentor to guide me in adapting to the new academic environment but didn't get one. I hope future generations will have mentors at all UNICORE universities to help them complete their studies with fewer struggles."

UNICORE 2025 Survey – Key Recommendations

- Improve **post-graduation** support:
Develop job placement services, mentorships, internships, and networking. Consider grace period support.
- Strengthen **documentation** processes:
Streamline residence permit and CTD procedures to reduce delays.
- Increase **financial support**:
Effectively exempt scholarships from taxes, ensure timely payments and harmonize support across universities.
- Improve **coordination among partners**:
Define roles clearly, ensure accountability, and conduct regular checks by UNHCR.
- Address **bullying and discrimination**:
Implement prevention measures and clear reporting channels.
- Enhance **psychological support**:
Provide mental health services and monitor student well-being regularly.

Next Steps

- ✓ Share findings with universities and partners
- ✓ Improve coordination and service delivery
- ✓ Strengthen mental health and post-graduation support



Grazie!

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